Improving VIU Subscription Interface — Variant B

Design recommendations for a cleaner layout, more consistent colours, and clearer subscription choices.

1. Recommended colour palette

Use a warm off-white background, white subscription cards, deep navy text, and one restrained teal accent. This creates a polished, modern interface while keeping the price and billing information easy to scan.

Element	Colour	HEX	Purpose
Main page background	Warm off-white	#F7F7F5	Softens the page while maintaining a light, uncluttered appearance.
Subscription cards	White	#FFFFFF	Separates each plan clearly from the background.
Main text and prices	Deep navy	#172B4D	Creates a consistent, professional text hierarchy.
Secondary text	Slate grey	#667085	Keeps supporting details readable without competing with key information.
Primary CTA button	Deep teal	#087E8B	Provides one distinctive accent for the main action.
CTA button text	White	#FFFFFF	Maintains clear contrast against the teal button.
Savings / selected state	Dark teal	#087E8B	Connects savings and selection cues to the main accent; use sparingly.
Card borders / dividers	Light grey	#E4E7EC	Separates sections without adding visual clutter.
Billing / cancellation text	Dark grey		Keeps contractual and financial details legible.

Overall look: warm off-white background + white cards + navy text + teal buttons + restrained grey dividers.

2. Suggested page layout

A. Top section — make the choice understandable

Heading: “Choose your VIU plan”

Supporting line: “Compare your options and review the full cost before subscribing.”

- Use a simple, uncluttered heading with a clear hierarchy.
- Keep the billing options (e.g., monthly and annual, if present in the prototype) visible in a compact toggle or selection bar.
- Use a clear selected state; avoid unnecessary gradients, badges, or decorative graphics.

B. Middle section — simplify the subscription cards

Keep the cards white, with thin borders, rounded corners, and consistent spacing.

- Plan name first, followed by price and billing frequency.
- List key inclusions in a consistent format.
- Show savings only where the calculation is accurate and easy to verify.
- Place the primary action button at the same vertical position across cards.
- Suggested styling: 12–16 px corner radius, 24 px internal padding, 20 px plan name, and 32–36 px price.

C. Selected plan — highlight without over-promoting

Use a 2 px teal border for the selected plan and a 1 px light-grey border for unselected plans. Keep both backgrounds white. A small “Selected plan” label is preferable to an unjustified “Recommended” or “Best value” badge.

D. Bottom section — clarify payment information

Use a clearly separated section titled “Billing details”, with a subtle grey divider above it.

- Amount charged today.
- Billing frequency and next billing date.
- Whether the subscription automatically renews.
- Any additional fees, if applicable.
- Cancellation conditions and relevant deadlines.

Keep financial and contractual information readable. Do not rely on low-contrast fine print or use red/green colour coding for prices and fee disclosures.

3. Changes to make to the existing Variant B

Current element	Recommended change	Rationale
Dark subscription cards	Change to white cards on a warm off-white background.	Creates a lighter page that is easier to scan.
Amber “Annual Billing” button	Use the same teal accent as the primary action system.	Avoids competing accent colours.
Green ticks and savings text	Use teal selectively rather than colouring every positive element.	Reduces visual competition.
Green transparency badge / protocol bar	Remove unless it communicates a specific, substantiated benefit.	Avoids implying reassurance without meaningful evidence.
Gold price on bundle card	Use the same deep navy price styling as other plans.	Makes prices easier to compare.
Multiple highlight colours	Limit the palette to navy, teal, white, and neutral greys.	Creates a coherent visual language.
Inconsistent cancellation / fee styling	Use one consistent disclosure style for financial and contractual information.	Helps users locate important details.
Uneven card spacing / buttons	Standardise card heights, padding, and button alignment.	Makes comparison more organised.

4. Important experimental-design consideration

Because the project examines decision architecture, separate visual polish from the effects you intend to test. Colour can influence attention and perceptions, so if Variants A and B use different palettes, a change in participant behaviour may be due to colour, layout, decision architecture, or a combination.

Option 1 — Test decision architecture

Keep the palette, typography, card styling, and button appearance consistent between A and B. Change only the decision-architecture elements under investigation. This makes the comparison easier to interpret.

Option 2 — Test a complete redesign

Use the new palette and layout in Variant B, but acknowledge that several elements change at once. A better outcome cannot be attributed to colour, layout, or decision architecture individually.

If time and participant numbers allow, test layout and colour separately. Otherwise, the first option is the cleaner experimental design.

5. Ready-to-use design prompt

> *Redesign Variant B of the VIU subscription interface using a clean, modern, minimalist layout. Use a warm off-white background (#F7F7F5), white subscription cards (#FFFFFF), deep navy text (#172B4D), teal primary buttons (#087E8B), light-grey borders (#E4E7EC), and slate-grey secondary text (#667085). Keep subscription cards consistent in height, padding, typography, and spacing, with prices clearly visible and billing frequency stated beside them. Use teal sparingly for the primary action, selected states, and accurately calculated savings. Align action buttons across cards. Include a clearly organised billing-details section that makes the amount charged today, billing frequency, renewal conditions, additional fees, and cancellation terms easy to locate and read. Avoid unnecessary badges, decorative gradients, excessive colour coding, and promotional labels that imply a plan is superior without justification. Maintain a polished streaming-service aesthetic while prioritising readability, transparent pricing, and informed user choice.*

6. Final recommendation

Use the warm off-white + white cards + navy text + teal accent palette. It should be visually polished, easy to present, and supported by a clear design rationale. Keep the palette consistent across both variants if colour is not one of the variables being tested.